



Please reply to: -  
Jim Harris, Chairman,  
C/o Health Claims Bureau Limited,  
5, Abingdon Road,  
DIDCOT, Oxfordshire, OX11 9BL  
Tel. 01235 519924

e-mail [jharris@hcbgroup.co.uk](mailto:jharris@hcbgroup.co.uk)

Statement from Jim Harris, on behalf of the DISPA, (Disability Insurance Service Providers Association).

DISPA was formed in December 2001, with a view to raising and maintaining standards of professionalism and expertise amongst providers of services to Disability Insurance carriers, primarily focussed on serving the Health Claims Forum membership. There are currently 16 member organisations comprising DISPA.

The organisation grew and through the years, DISPA members have written and updated "Best Practise" notes, held workshops, conferences and meetings all designed to improve claims handlers knowledge and understanding of the wide range of services available through the membership. The intended "quid pro quo" for the significant investment in time and commitment, was engagement from the HCF members to recognise this considerable effort, by making use of the wide range of services available.

The notion was that HCF members might choose DISPA members over non DISPA members as suppliers of services, knowing that DISPA members would adhere to the high professional and ethical standards required from membership. Sadly, there is no evidence that this has worked. Moreover, most DISPA members no longer see anywhere near sufficient business volume from HCF member companies to sustain the investment required to keep DISPA running in a meaningful way.

The membership has, very reluctantly, decided to shut down DISPA, and a resolution was today unanimously carried by the membership to do so. It will now be for individual service providers to demonstrate their standards and professionalism to potential clients, and for claims managers and procurement processes to satisfy themselves of supplier eligibility.

Friday, 2<sup>nd</sup> August, 2013.